

SUPREME COURT

APEX COURT, INTEGRATED HIERARCHY → APPOINTMENT TEXT, COLLEGIUM EVOLUTION → QUALIFICATIONS, SERVICE CONDITIONS AND → INDEPENDENCE AND ACCOUNTABILITY MUST → JURISDICTION GATEWAY AND THE → APPEALS, SPECIAL LEAVE AND

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 APEX COURT, INTEGRATED HIERARCHY AND INSTITUTIONAL IDENTITY

APEX COURT, INTEGRATED HIERARCHY AND INSTITUTIONAL IDENTITY ARTICLES 124-147, PART V UNION JUDICIARY PRIVY COUNCIL FEDERAL COURT (1937) CONSTITUTION (26 JAN 1950) SC (28 JAN 1950) SUPREME COURT

ARTICLES 124-147, PART V: UNION JUDICIARY

Privy Council → Federal Court (1937) → Constitution (26 Jan 1950) → SC (28 Jan

SUPREME COURT → HIGH COURTS → SUBORDINATE COURTS one hierarchy applies Union + State law

LIMIT: integrated does not mean unitary administration; Articles 226, 227 and 235 remain vital.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLES 124-147, PART V: UNION JUDICIARY
- Privy Council → Federal Court (1937) → Constitution (26 Jan 1950) → SC (28 Jan 1950)
- SUPREME COURT → HIGH COURTS → SUBORDINATE COURTS one hierarchy applies Union + State law; Article 141 promotes national legal uniformity.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- LIMIT: integrated does not mean unitary administration; Articles 226, 227 and 235 remain vital.
- CONTROL CARD, 28 AUG 2026 sanctioned 38 including CJI
- working strength: live roster

CHECK / LIMIT

- retirement 65 seat Delhi, Article 130
- Article 145(3): five-judge minimum for specified questions.
- MUST REMEMBER: Map Articles 124-147 with exact appointment, qualification, tenure, removal, independence, jurisdiction, precedent, review, contempt and complete-justice

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- do not merge Article 32, 136, 137, 141, 142 or 143.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Map Articles 124-147 with exact appointment, qualification, tenure, removal, independence, jurisdiction, precedent, review, contempt and complete-justice rules; do not merge Article 32, 136, 137, 141, 142 or 143.

01

STAGE 01 APPOINTMENT TEXT, COLLEGIUM EVOLUTION AND NJAC TEST

APPOINTMENT TEXT, COLLEGIUM EVOLUTION AND NJAC TEST ARTICLE 124 PRESIDENT APPOINTS CONSTITUTIONALLY REQUIRED CONSULTATION CURRENT OPERATION COLLEGIUM RECOMMENDATION UNION PROCESSING PRESIDENTIAL APPOINTMENT.

ARTICLE 124: PRESIDENT APPOINTS → CONSTITUTIONALLY REQUIRED CONSULTATION

Current operation: collegium recommendation → Union processing → presidential appointment.

First Judges Case (1981) → executive primacy

Second Judges Case (1993) → judicial primacy; collegium created

Third Judges Case (1998) → SC collegium: CJI + four senior-most judges

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLE 124: PRESIDENT APPOINTS → CONSTITUTIONALLY REQUIRED CONSULTATION
- Current operation: collegium recommendation → Union processing → presidential appointment.
- First Judges Case (1981) → executive primacy

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Second Judges Case (1993) → judicial primacy; collegium created
- Third Judges Case (1998) → SC collegium: CJI + four senior-most judges
- 2014 99th Amendment + NJAC Act → six-member commission

CHECK / LIMIT

- Fourth Judges Case (2015) → NJAC invalid; collegium restored
- CJI SENIORITY: settled convention reflected in MoP, not express constitutional text.
- REFORM TEST: transparent criteria + diversity + time discipline without executive capture.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Second Judges Case (1993) → judicial primacy; collegium created

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: REFORM TEST: transparent criteria + diversity + time discipline without executive capture.

02

STAGE 02 QUALIFICATIONS, SERVICE CONDITIONS AND REMOVAL ROUTE

QUALIFICATIONS, SERVICE CONDITIONS AND REMOVAL ROUTE INDIAN CITIZEN + FIVE YEARS HC JUDGE OR TEN OR DISTINGUISHED JURIST IN THE PRESIDENT'S OPINION; NO MINIMUM SECURE TENURE TO 65 RESIGNATION TO PRESIDENT OR ARTICLE 124(4) REMOVAL PROVED MISBEHAVIOUR/INCAPACITY

SPECIAL MAJORITY IN EACH HOUSE PRESIDENTIAL ORDER; CONSTITUTION SAYS REMOVAL, NOT IMPEACHMENT.

ELIGIBILITY → Indian citizen + five years HC judge OR ten years HC advocate

OR distinguished jurist in the President's opinion; no minimum age.

OATH → secure tenure to 65 → resignation to President OR Article 124(4) removal

REMOVAL: proved misbehaviour/incapacity → inquiry → special majority in each House

presidential order; Constitution says removal, not impeachment.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ELIGIBILITY → Indian citizen + five years HC judge OR ten years HC advocate
- OR distinguished jurist in the President's opinion; no minimum age.
- OATH → secure tenure to 65 → resignation to President OR Article 124(4) removal

POWER / PROCEDURE

- REMOVAL: proved misbehaviour/incapacity → inquiry → special majority in each House
- presidential order; Constitution says removal, not impeachment.
- FINANCIAL FIREWALL salary charged under Article 112(3)(d)(i)

CHECK / LIMIT

- conditions protected by Article 125
- Court administrative expenses charged under Article 146(3).
- Article 124(7): former SC judge cannot plead or act before any Indian court/authority.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- REMOVAL: proved misbehaviour/incapacity → inquiry → special majority in each House

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FINANCIAL FIREWALL salary charged under Article 112(3)(d)(i) | conditions protected by Article 125.

02

STAGE 02

QUALIFICATIONS, SERVICE CONDITIONS AND REMOVAL ROUTE

QUALIFICATIONS, SERVICE CONDITIONS AND REMOVAL ROUTEINDIAN CITIZEN + FIVE YEARS HC JUDGE OR TENOR DISTINGUISHED JURIST IN THE PRESIDENT'S OPINION; NO MINIMUMSECURE TENURE TO 65RESIGNATION TO PRESIDENT OR ARTICLE 124(4) REMOVALPROVED MISBEHAVIOUR/INCAPACITY

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presidential order; Constitution says removal, not impeachment.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ELIGIBILITY → Indian citizen + five years HC judge OR ten years HC advocate
- OR distinguished jurist in the President's opinion; no minimum age.
- OATH → secure tenure to 65 → resignation to President OR Article 124(4) removal

POWER / PROCEDURE

- REMOVAL: proved misbehaviour/incapacity → inquiry → special majority in each House
- presidential order; Constitution says removal, not impeachment.
- FINANCIAL FIREWALL salary charged under Article 112(3)(d)(i)

CHECK / LIMIT

- conditions protected by Article 125
- Court administrative expenses charged under Article 146(3).
- Article 124(7): former SC judge cannot plead or act before any Indian court/authority.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- REMOVAL: proved misbehaviour/incapacity → inquiry → special majority in each House

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FINANCIAL FIREWALL salary charged under Article 112(3)(d)(i) | conditions protected by Article 125.

03

STAGE 03

INDEPENDENCE AND ACCOUNTABILITY MUST OPERATE TOGETHER

INDEPENDENCE AND ACCOUNTABILITY MUST OPERATE TOGETHERINDEPENDENCE SHIELD APPOINTMENT INSULATIONPROTECTED CONDITIONSARTICLE 121ARTICLE 129ARTICLE 50 SEPARATIONBINDING AUTHORITYADMINISTRATIVE AND FINANCIAL AUTONOMY

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- INDEPENDENCE SHIELD appointment insulation
- protected conditions
- Article 121

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Article 129
- Article 50 separation
- binding authority

CHECK / LIMIT

- administrative and financial autonomy
- ACCOUNTABILITY CHANNELS reasoned judgments + recusals + disclosure + published collegium resolutions
- 1997 Restatement + 1999 in-house procedure: non-statutory

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Article 124(4): extreme removal endpoint; no SC judge has been removed.
- DIALECTIC independence without accountability → opacity accountability without insulation → political compliance
- VERDICT → independent decisions + transparent institutional process.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → independent decisions + transparent institutional process.

04

STAGE 04

JURISDICTION GATEWAY AND THE FEDERAL-RIGHTS ROUTES

JURISDICTION GATEWAY AND THE FEDERAL-RIGHTS ROUTESCHOOSE THE CONSTITUTIONAL DOOR FEDERAL LEGAL DISPUTE AMONG LISTEDARTICLE 131, EXCLUSIVE ORIGINALFUNDAMENTAL RIGHT ENFORCEMENTARTICLE 32, ITSELF A FUNDAMENTAL RIGHT OTHER PUBLIC-LAW RIGHT

HIGH COURT ARTICLE 226, WIDER IN PURPOSEFIVE WRITS HABEAS CORPUSPUBLIC DUTY

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
CHOOSE THE CONSTITUTIONAL DOOR federal legal dispute among listed governments → Article 131, exclusive original	FIVE WRITS habeas corpus: liberty	prohibition: stop proceeding certiorari: quash completed order	ARTICLE 131 LIMITS eligible parties + existence/extent of legal right; not a political mediation forum.
Fundamental Right enforcement → Article 32, itself a Fundamental Right other public-law right → High Court Article 226, wider in purpose	mandamus: public duty	quo warranto: test public office	Treaty proviso and Article 262 water-dispute exclusion must be checked.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- CHOOSE THE CONSTITUTIONAL DOOR federal legal dispute among listed governments → Article 131, exclusive original
- Fundamental Right enforcement → Article 32, itself a Fundamental Right other public-law right → High Court Article 226, wider in purpose

POWER / PROCEDURE

- FIVE WRITS habeas corpus: liberty
- mandamus: public duty

CHECK / LIMIT

- prohibition: stop proceeding certiorari: quash completed order
- quo warranto: test public office

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- ARTICLE 131 LIMITS eligible parties + existence/extent of legal right; not a political mediation forum.
- Treaty proviso and Article 262 water-dispute exclusion must be checked.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Treaty proviso and Article 262 water-dispute exclusion must be checked.

05

STAGE 05

APPEALS, SPECIAL LEAVE AND PRESIDENTIAL REFERENCE

APPEALS, SPECIAL LEAVE AND PRESIDENTIAL REFERENCEAPPELLATE ROUTESARTICLE 132CERTIFICATE PROCESSARTICLE 136EXTRAORDINARY DISCRETIONARY SPECIAL LEAVE, NOT A REGULAR FOURTH APPEALARTICLE 143 ADVISORY ROUTEPUBLIC-IMPORTANCE QUESTION; COURT MAY REPORT OPINION

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
APPELLATE ROUTES	Article 136: extraordinary discretionary special leave, not a regular fourth appeal no SLP from Armed Forces courts or tribunals.	2025 ASSENT OPINION: no rigid court-made timelines or automatic deemed assent	Structure, PIL and judicial legislation proposition-specific.
Article 132: constitutional	ARTICLE 143 ADVISORY ROUTE	prolonged unexplained inaction remains reviewable. Use as dated, issue-specific evidence.	Article 142 supplies complete justice in a cause or matter, not free-standing power to ignore substantive law.
133: civil	143(1): public-importance question; Court may report opinion	State of Tamil Nadu v. Governor of Tamil Nadu (2025) → facts-specific assent relief.	
134: criminal	143(2): dispute within Article 131 proviso; Court shall hear and report	In re Assent, Withholding or Reservation of Bills (2025) → advisory control.	

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

POWER / PROCEDURE

CHECK / LIMIT

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Treaty proviso and Article 262 water-dispute exclusion must be checked.

05

STAGE 05 APPEALS, SPECIAL LEAVE AND PRESIDENTIAL REFERENCE

APPEALS, SPECIAL LEAVE AND PRESIDENTIAL REFERENCE APPELLATE ROUTES ARTICLE 132 CERTIFICATE PROCESS ARTICLE 136 EXTRAORDINARY DISCRETIONARY SPECIAL LEAVE, NOT A REGULAR FOURTH APPEAL ARTICLE 143 ADVISORY ROUTE PUBLIC-IMPORTANCE QUESTION; COURT MAY REPORT OPINION

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
APPELLATE ROUTES	Article 136: extraordinary discretionary special leave, not a regular fourth appeal no SLP from Armed Forces courts or tribunals.	2025 ASSENT OPINION: no rigid court-made timelines or automatic deemed assent	Structure, PIL and judicial legislation proposition-specific.
Article 132: constitutional	ARTICLE 143 ADVISORY ROUTE	prolonged unexplained inaction remains reviewable. Use as dated, issue-specific evidence.	Article 142 supplies complete justice in a cause or matter, not free-standing power to ignore substantive law.
133: civil	143(1): public-importance question; Court may report opinion	State of Tamil Nadu v. Governor of Tamil Nadu (2025) → facts-specific assent relief.	
134: criminal	143(2): dispute within Article 131 proviso; Court shall hear and report	In re Assent, Withholding or Reservation of Bills (2025) → advisory control.	

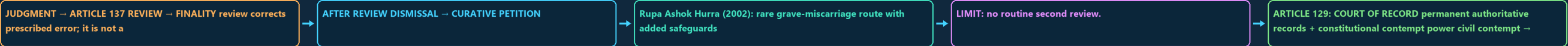
CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
• APPELLATE ROUTES • Article 132: constitutional • 133: civil • 134: criminal • 134A: certificate process	• Article 136: extraordinary discretionary special leave, not a regular fourth appeal no SLP from Armed Forces courts or tribunals. • ARTICLE 143 ADVISORY ROUTE • 143(1): public-importance question; Court may report opinion • 143(2): dispute within Article 131 proviso; Court shall hear and report • Opinion remains advisory, not an ordinary binding decree.	• 2025 ASSENT OPINION: no rigid court-made timelines or automatic deemed assent • prolonged unexplained inaction remains reviewable. Use as dated, issue-specific evidence. • State of Tamil Nadu v. Governor of Tamil Nadu (2025) → facts-specific assent relief. • In re Assent, Withholding or Reservation of Bills (2025) → advisory control. • CLOSE DISTINCTION: Keep collegium doctrine, NJAC invalidation, judicial review, Basic	• Structure, PIL and judicial legislation proposition-specific. • Article 142 supplies complete justice in a cause or matter, not free-standing power to ignore substantive law.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Structure, PIL and judicial legislation proposition-specific. Article 142 supplies complete justice in a cause or matter, not free-standing power to ignore substantive law.

06

STAGE 06 FINALITY, REVIEW, CURATIVE POWER AND CONTEMPT

FINALITY, REVIEW, CURATIVE POWER AND CONTEMPT ARTICLE 137 REVIEW FINALITY REVIEW CORRECTS PRESCRIBED ERROR; IT IS NOT A AFTER REVIEW DISMISSAL CURATIVE PETITION RUPA ASHOK HURRA (2002) RARE GRAVE-MISCARRIAGE ROUTE WITH ADDED SAFEGUARDS NO ROUTINE SECOND REVIEW.



CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
• JUDGMENT → ARTICLE 137 REVIEW → FINALITY review corrects prescribed error; it is not a rehearing of the appeal. • AFTER REVIEW DISMISSAL → CURATIVE PETITION	• Rupa Ashok Hurra (2002): rare grave-miscarriage route with added safeguards • LIMIT: no routine second review.	• ARTICLE 129: COURT OF RECORD permanent authoritative records + constitutional contempt power civil contempt → wilful disobedience • criminal contempt → substantial interference fair criticism and statutory truth defence protect speech; power protects justice, not ego.	• JUDGMENT → ARTICLE 137 REVIEW → FINALITY review corrects prescribed error; it is not a rehearing of the appeal. • AFTER REVIEW DISMISSAL → CURATIVE PETITION

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ARTICLE 129: COURT OF RECORD permanent authoritative records + constitutional contempt power civil contempt → wilful disobedience | criminal contempt → substantial interference fair criticism and statutory truth defence protect speech; power protects justice, not ego.

07

STAGE 07 PRECEDENT, COMPLETE JUSTICE, ASSISTANCE AND PROCEDURE

PRECEDENT, COMPLETE JUSTICE, ASSISTANCE AND PROCEDURE ARTICLE 141 RATIO OF LAW DECLARED BINDS ALL COURTS LARGER BENCH ARTICLE 142 COMPLETE JUSTICE IN THE CAUSE OR MATTER BEFORE THE PREM CHAND GARG CANNOT VIOLATE FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS

SUPREME COURT BAR ASSOCIATION (1998)



CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
• ARTICLE 141 → ratio of law declared binds all courts larger Bench smaller Bench; coordinate disagreement ordinarily goes to larger Bench. • ARTICLE 142 → complete justice in the cause or matter before the Court • Prem Chand Garg → cannot violate Fundamental Rights	• Supreme Court Bar Association (1998) → cannot supplant substantive law. • ARTICLE 144 → civil and judicial authorities act in aid. • ARTICLE 145 → rules; five-judge floor for Article 143 and substantial interpretation.	• CONTINUITY TOOLS • 126 acting CJI • 127 ad hoc judge	• 128 retired judge sitting: distinct consent routes.

07

STAGE 07PRECEDENT, COMPLETE JUSTICE, ASSISTANCE AND PROCEDURE

PRECEDENT, COMPLETE JUSTICE, ASSISTANCE AND PROCEDUREARTICLE 141RATIO OF LAW DECLARED BINDS ALL COURTS LARGER BENCHARTICLE 142COMPLETE JUSTICE IN THE CAUSE OR MATTER BEFORE THEPREM CHAND GARGCANNOT VIOLATE FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS

SUPREME COURT BAR ASSOCIATION (1998)

ARTICLE 141 → ratio of law declared binds all courts larger Bench smaller Bench; coordinate

ARTICLE 142 → complete justice in the cause or matter before the Court

Prem Chand Garg → cannot violate Fundamental Rights

Supreme Court Bar Association (1998) → cannot supplant substantive law.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLE 141 → ratio of law declared binds all courts larger Bench smaller Bench; coordinate disagreement ordinarily goes to larger Bench.
- ARTICLE 142 → complete justice in the cause or matter before the Court
- Prem Chand Garg → cannot violate Fundamental Rights

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Supreme Court Bar Association (1998) → cannot supplant substantive law.
- ARTICLE 144 → civil and judicial authorities act in aid.
- ARTICLE 145 → rules; five-judge floor for Article 143 and substantial interpretation.

CHECK / LIMIT

- CONTINUITY TOOLS
- 126 acting CJI
- 127 ad hoc judge

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- 128 retired judge sitting: distinct consent routes.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 126 acting CJI | 127 ad hoc judge | 128 retired judge sitting: distinct consent routes.

08

STAGE 08JUDICIAL REVIEW, BASIC STRUCTURE, NINTH SCHEDULE AND TRIBUNALS

JUDICIAL REVIEW, BASIC STRUCTURE, NINTH SCHEDULE AND TRIBUNALSCONSTITUTIONAL SUPREMACYREVIEW OF LAW + EXECUTIVE ACTION + AMENDMENT EFFECTKESAVANANDA BHARATI (1973)AMENDMENT CANNOT DAMAGE BASIC STRUCTUREMINERVA MILLS (1980)

LIMITED POWER + PARTS III-IV HARMONYI.R. COELHO (2007)

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- CONSTITUTIONAL SUPREMACY → REVIEW OF LAW + EXECUTIVE ACTION + AMENDMENT EFFECT
- Kesavananda Bharati (1973) → amendment cannot damage Basic Structure
- Minerva Mills (1980) → limited power + Parts III-IV harmony

POWER / PROCEDURE

- I.R. Coelho (2007) → post-24 Apr 1973 Ninth Schedule insertions face impact review
- LIMIT: reviewability is not automatic invalidity.
- TRIBUNAL FLOOR

CHECK / LIMIT

- L. Chandra Kumar (1997) → tribunals may supplement adjudication
- BUT Articles 226/227 High Court review and Article 32 review cannot be wholly excluded.
- Specialisation remains under constitutional-court supervision.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- I.R. Coelho (2007) → post-24 Apr 1973 Ninth Schedule insertions face impact review

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BUT Articles 226/227 High Court review and Article 32 review cannot be wholly excluded.

09

STAGE 09PIL, ACTIVISM, JUDICIAL LEGISLATION AND ENVIRONMENT

PIL, ACTIVISM, JUDICIAL LEGISLATION AND ENVIRONMENTACCESS EXPANSION RELAXED LOCUS STANDI + EPISTOLARY JURISDICTION +HUSSAINARA KHATOON (1979)SPEEDY TRIALS.P. GUPTA (1981)REPRESENTATIVE STANDINGSTANDING IS RELAXED, NOT ERASED; SCREEN BONA FIDES AND

JUDICIAL LEGISLATION

ACCESS EXPANSION relaxed locus standi + epistolary jurisdiction + continuing mandamus

Hussainara Khatoon (1979): speedy trial

S.P. Gupta (1981): representative standing

LIMIT: standing is relaxed, not erased; screen bona fides and administrability.

JUDICIAL LEGISLATION

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ACCESS EXPANSION relaxed locus standi + epistolary jurisdiction + continuing mandamus
- Hussainara Khatoon (1979): speedy trial
- S.P. Gupta (1981): representative standing

POWER / PROCEDURE

- LIMIT: standing is relaxed, not erased; screen bona fides and administrability.
- JUDICIAL LEGISLATION
- Vishaka (1997): rights-based interim norm in legal vacuum until 2013 legislation legitimacy

CHECK / LIMIT

- test → right + vacuum + necessity + temporary, legally anchored remedy.
- ENVIRONMENTAL LINE
- Article 21 + 48A + 51A(g) → absolute liability, precaution, polluter pays, public trust

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Court catalyses compliance; CPCB, State boards and NGT remain indispensable.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Court catalyses compliance; CPCB, State boards and NGT remain indispensable.

10

STAGE 10COMPARISON, DIVERSITY, PROFESSION AND DELIVERY REFORM

COMPARISON, DIVERSITY, PROFESSION AND DELIVERY REFORMEQUALITY + LEGITIMACY + WIDER PROFESSIONAL PIPELINEFATHIMA BEEVI (1989)FIRST WOMAN SC JUDGE; AVOID UNDATED PERCENTAGES.SHARED PRECEDENT; CONSTITUTIONAL SUPREMACY VERSUS PARLIAMENTARY SOVEREIGNTY

COLLEGIUM + RETIREMENT 65 VERSUS NOMINATION + SENATE +STATE BAR COUNCILS ENROL; BCI SETS NATIONAL STATUTORY STANDARDSBCI IS STATUTORY, NOT CONSTITUTIONAL; COURTS RETAIN PRACTICE AND

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

DIVERSITY → equality + legitimacy + wider professional pipeline

Fathima Beevi (1989): first woman SC judge; avoid undated percentages.

POWER / PROCEDURE

INDIA-UK → shared precedent: constitutional supremacy versus parliamentary sovereignty

INDIA-USA → collegium + retirement 65 versus nomination + Senate + good-behaviour tenure

CHECK / LIMIT

PROFESSION → State Bar Councils enrol; BCI sets national statutory standards and appeals

BCI is statutory, not constitutional; courts retain practice and proceeding rules.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

DELIVERY CHAIN accessible filing → timely listing/hearing → reasoned order → implementation technology + legal aid + judges + case management

e-Courts alone cannot cure exclusion.

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mandamus

- Hussainara Khatoon (1979): speedy trial
- S.P. Gupta (1981): representative standing

- JUDICIAL LEGISLATION
 - Vishaka (1997): rights-based interim norm in legal vacuum until 2013 legislation legitimacy

- ENVIRONMENTAL LINE
 - Article 21 + 48A + 51A(g) → absolute liability, precaution, polluter pays, public trust

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Court catalyses compliance; CPCB, State boards and NGT remain indispensable.

10

STAGE 10

COMPARISON, DIVERSITY, PROFESSION AND DELIVERY REFORM

COMPARISON, DIVERSITY, PROFESSION AND DELIVERY REFORM

EQUALITY + LEGITIMACY + WIDER PROFESSIONAL PIPELINE

FATHIMA BEEVI (1989)

FIRST WOMAN SC JUDGE; AVOID UNDATED PERCENTAGES.

SHARED PRECEDENT; CONSTITUTIONAL SUPREMACY VERSUS PARLIAMENTARY SOVEREIGNTY

COLLEGIUM + RETIREMENT 65 VERSUS NOMINATION + SENATE +

STATE BAR COUNCILS ENROL; BCI SETS NATIONAL STATUTORY STANDARDS

BCI IS STATUTORY, NOT CONSTITUTIONAL; COURTS RETAIN PRACTICE AND

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
DIVERSITY → equality + legitimacy + wider professional pipeline	INDIA-UK → shared precedent; constitutional supremacy versus parliamentary sovereignty	PROFESSION → State Bar Councils enrol; BCI sets national statutory standards and appeals	DELIVERY CHAIN accessible filing → timely listing/hearing → reasoned order → implementation technology + legal aid + judges + case management
Fathima Beevi (1989): first woman SC judge; avoid undated percentages.	INDIA-USA → collegium + retirement 65 versus nomination + Senate + good-behaviour tenure	BCI is statutory, not constitutional; courts retain practice and proceeding rules.	e-Courts alone cannot cure exclusion.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- DIVERSITY → equality + legitimacy + wider professional pipeline
- Fathima Beevi (1989): first woman SC judge; avoid undated percentages.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- INDIA-UK → shared precedent; constitutional supremacy versus parliamentary sovereignty
- INDIA-USA → collegium + retirement 65 versus nomination + Senate + good-behaviour tenure

CHECK / LIMIT

- PROFESSION → State Bar Councils enrol; BCI sets national statutory standards and appeals
- BCI is statutory, not constitutional; courts retain practice and proceeding rules.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- DELIVERY CHAIN accessible filing → timely listing/hearing → reasoned order → implementation technology + legal aid + judges + case management
- e-Courts alone cannot cure exclusion.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DELIVERY CHAIN accessible filing → timely listing/hearing → reasoned order → implementation technology + legal aid + judges + case management; e-Courts alone cannot cure exclusion.

11

STAGE 11

PRELIMS FIREWALLS, PYQ ROUTES AND EXAMINER-READY SYNTHESIS

PRELIMS FIREWALLS, PYQ ROUTES AND EXAMINER-READY SYNTHESIS

PRELIMS FIREWALL

ARTICLE 32 NARROWER IN PURPOSE THAN 226

ARTICLE 136 DISCRETIONARY

143 ADVISORY

ARTICLE 142 BOUNDED

CONSTITUTION BENCH MINIMUM FIVE

CURATIVE IS EXCEPTIONAL COLLEGIUM NOT CONSTITUTIONAL TEXT

PRELIMS FIREWALL

→

Article 32 narrower in purpose than 226

→

Article 136 discretionary

→

143 advisory

→

Article 142 bounded

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- PRELIMS FIREWALL - Article 32 narrower in purpose than 226 - Article 136 discretionary 143 advisory - Article 142 bounded	- curative is exceptional collegium not constitutional text - removal is not impeachment - working strength is dated. - PYQ ROUTES - judicial legislation/PIL	- PIL and judicial power - constitutional morality - India-USA appointments. - MAINS SPINE define institutional role → Article → mechanism → case + year → consequence - counterpoint/limit → matched reform → qualified conclusion.	- to reasoned restraint, accountable process, accessible remedies and executable orders. - LEGAL/SOURCE LIMIT: Act 14 of 2026 raises the statutory maximum to thirty-seven judges excluding - the CJ, total sanctioned strength thirty-eight, deemed in force from 16 May 2026. - Working strength and pendency remain dynamic.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LEGAL/SOURCE LIMIT: Act 14 of 2026 raises the statutory maximum to thirty-seven judges excluding the CJ, total sanctioned strength thirty-eight, deemed in force from 16 May 2026.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

A1. CONSTITUTION BENCHES, PRECEDENT AND INSTITUTIONAL VOICE

A2. ARTICLE 141 AND ARTICLE 142 ARE DIFFERENT POWERS

A3. THE COURT'S POWER AND ITS COMPLIANCE DEPENDENCY

A4. CONTINUING MANDAMUS

REMEDY OR ADMINISTRATION?

A5. APPOINTMENT REFORM MATRIX

A6. CONCISE SOURCE AND CURRENT-CONTROL NOTE

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE	ADVANCED LIMIT	COMPARATIVE NUANCE
- A1. Constitution Benches, precedent and institutional voice - A2. Article 141 and Article 142 are different powers - A3. The Court's power and its compliance dependency - A4. Continuing mandamus: remedy or administration?	- A5. Appointment reform matrix - A6. Concise source and current-control note [FACT] Article 145(3) creates a five-judge minimum, not a five-judge maximum. [FACT] Ratio and bench strength determine binding authority under Article 141.	[ANALYSIS] Frequent small-bench adjudication improves throughput but can create fragmentation when nationally important issues are not referred promptly. [LIMIT] A later small bench cannot silently neutralise a larger bench; genuine conflict requires reference. [ANALYSIS] Confusing the two converts a case-specific remedy into a general - law or, conversely, understates the precedential principle that actually binds.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.